

EXPLICIT CONSENT FORM – INTERVIEW STUDY ON GRID CONGESTION

PARTICIPANT INFORMATION / OPENING STATEMENT

You are being invited to participate in a research project conducted by a group of six students from Delft University of Technology (TU Delft) in collaboration with the Rijksvastgoedbedrijf (RVB). The purpose of this study is to explore potential strategies for mitigating electricity grid congestion and to identify solutions that RVB could apply in its real-estate portfolio.

Your participation involves taking part in a semi-structured interview about your professional experience and perspectives on grid congestion, energy infrastructure, and possible technical or organizational measures to reduce congestion.

The information collected during this interview will be used solely for academic research purposes within this project and to inform recommendations to RVB. The interview data will only be accessible to the student research team, TU Delft supervisors, and representatives of RVB. In all research outputs, participants will be referred to only as a “employee of” the relevant organization. Names and other directly identifying details will not be included.

Any personal data will be handled confidentially and in accordance with the General Data Protection Regulation (GDPR). Data will be pseudonymised, access will be restricted to the research team, and files will be archived for the duration of the project and any required academic retention period, after which they will be deleted.

Participation in this study carries minimal risk. However, there is a small possibility of sensitivity due to the professional nature of the topic. This risk will be mitigated by anonymisation, careful handling of quotations, and restricting access to the interview material.

Your participation is entirely voluntary. You may decline to answer any question and may withdraw from the study at any time without providing a reason. If you choose to withdraw, you may request that your data be removed from the study within a reasonable timeframe, provided analysis has not yet been completed.

You will not receive financial compensation for participation, and no travel reimbursement is offered.

A. General Agreement – Research Goals, Tasks, and Voluntary Participation

1. I have read and understood the Participant Information.

☒ Yes ☐ No

2. I voluntarily agree to take part in this study and understand that I may refuse to answer any question and withdraw at any time without giving a reason.

☒ Yes ☐ No

3. I understand that my participation involves a semi-structured interview about grid congestion and possible mitigation strategies, and that the interview may be audio-recorded and transcribed for research purposes.

☒ Yes ☐ No

4. I understand that I will not receive financial compensation or reimbursement for participating in this study.

☒ Yes ☐ No

B. Potential Risks and Data Protection

5. I understand that participation involves minimal risk, but that there may be sensitivity due to the professional nature of the topic. I understand that this risk will be mitigated through anonymisation and restricted access to the data.

☒ Yes ☐ No

6. I understand that the following personally identifiable information may be collected: my name, job role, and organizational affiliation, and that this information will be pseudonymised in all research outputs.

☒ Yes ☐ No

7. I understand that no sensitive personal data as defined under GDPR (e.g., political views, religious beliefs, health data) is intentionally collected in this study.

☒ Yes ☐ No

8. I understand that the following measures will be taken to protect my data: secure TU Delft storage systems, restricted access to the research team and pseudonymisation of transcripts.

☒ Yes ☐ No

9. I understand that personal data that could identify me will not be shared beyond the student research team.

☒ Yes ☐ No

10. I understand that identifiable data will be deleted after completion of the project and mandatory TU Delft data retention requirements.

☒ Yes ☐ No

C. Research Outputs and Use of Data

11. I understand that de-identified information from this interview will be used in academic project reports and advisory outputs for the Rijksvastgoedbedrijf.

☒ Yes ☐ No

12. I agree that anonymous quotations from my interview may be used in research outputs.

☒ Yes ☐ No

13. I understand that my name will not be used in any publications or reports.

☒ Yes ☐ No

D. Data Storage and Future Use

14. I understand that anonymised interview transcripts may be archived on TU Delft systems for educational or auditing purposes related to this project, with restricted access.

☒ Yes ☐ No

SIGNATURE

Name of participant: Iwan Hoogenboom

Signature:  Date: 05-12-2025